

*zifelyo birtu'e hirfan nebero. Sawl kulu seb alem kem ziqyir zitsibeyo aynet seb'yu
zinebere — bikemey mkhwanu tiray ayifiltin neberu.)*

Scene 2

[PICTURE: A crowd of angry men dragging a young man named Stephen outside the city walls. Stephen's face is radiant and peaceful, looking upward toward heaven. Saul stands nearby, arms full of cloaks, watching with cold approval. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

The first time we meet Saul in Scripture, he is standing at a murder. Stephen — a young believer filled with the Holy Spirit — had preached boldly about Jesus being the Messiah. The religious leaders couldn't bear it. They dragged Stephen outside the city and began hurling stones at him. Saul didn't throw the stones himself, but he held the coats of those who did, giving his full approval. As Stephen died, he looked up and said, "Lord, do not hold this sin against them." Saul heard those words. A man being murdered was forgiving his killers. Something about that must have lodged deep in Saul's consciousness, even if he refused to acknowledge it.

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(Ab qidus tsihuf nimejemerta gize mis nirakbo Sawl ab qitlet dew ilu'yu zinebere. Istifanos — bimenfes qidus zimel'a hade min'isey amani — Yesus Mesih mkhwanu bidifret sebiku nebere. Itom nay haymanot merahiti kitsaw'rwo ayke'alun. Ni'Istifanos kab ketema gotitom a'iman kidirbiyo jemeru. Sawl ba'ilu a'iman ayderbeyen gin naytom ziderbeyu kidawiniti hizu milu'e simiminetu hibu. Istifanos kimewt kelo nila'ili temitu "Goyta iza hati'at ayti hazelom" bele. Sawl nezan qalat semi'en. Ziqtel zinebere

*seb niqeteltu yiqire yibil nebere. Wala kelaleyo inte abeye gele neger biza'ib'u ab
a'imro Sawl amiq ki'atu alewo.)*

Scene 3

[PICTURE: Saul leading armed temple guards through Jerusalem's streets at night, breaking into homes. Terrified Christian families are being dragged out — men, women, and children crying. Saul's face shows fierce determination without mercy. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

After Stephen's death, Saul didn't pause to reflect — he escalated. He began systematically destroying the church in Jerusalem. Going house to house, he dragged out men and women and threw them into prison. Families were torn apart. Children watched their parents hauled away. Saul did this not out of cruelty for its own sake, but out of sincere — yet terribly misguided — religious conviction. He genuinely believed he was serving God by eliminating what he saw as a dangerous heresy. This is perhaps the most frightening lesson of Saul's story: passion without love, zeal without wisdom, can make a person capable of terrible evil while believing they are doing good.

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(Dihri mot Istifanos Sawl dew ilu ayhhaseben — aberte'e. Ab Iyerusalem nibete Kristiyan bisir'at keatfi'e jemere. Geza nigeza inakede sebu'tin anisitin gotitu nab bet ma'iserti derbeyom. Sidrabetat tefelalyu. Qol'u weldom kigif'u re'ayu. Sawl nezi nchikane ba'ilu zeyikone biqinu'e — gin bi'azyu zitegageye — nay haymanot imnet'yu

*zigibero. Bihaqi ni'Amlak kem zigeglil yi'amin nebere hadegegna kihdet zire'ayo
bimitfae. Izi minalbat nay zanta Sawl zibeletsee zefrihi timhirti'yu; bizey fiqri hirfan
bizey tibeb qin'i hade seb tsbuq yigeber alekhu bizibil imnet zefrihi kif'at kigeber
ki'ilet kihibbo yikhil.)*

Scene 4

[PICTURE: Saul standing before the High Priest in the ornate temple chambers, receiving official letters with seals. His expression is eager and determined. Guards stand ready behind him with chains and weapons. A map showing the road to Damascus hangs on the wall. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Not content with persecuting Christians in Jerusalem alone, Saul's ambition grew. He went to the High Priest and requested official letters authorizing him to arrest any followers of "the Way" — as early Christians were called — in Damascus, over 200 kilometers away. His plan was to bind them and bring them back to Jerusalem for trial and punishment. Saul was breathing murderous threats against the Lord's disciples. His hatred had become his identity, his mission, his reason for living. He was a man consumed by what he thought was righteous fury — completely unaware that he was fighting against the very God he claimed to serve.

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(Ab Iyerusalem tiray Kristiyanat misigwag aye'igbon Sawl shewhat'u abeye. Nab liqe kahinat keydu ab Demasqo — li'ili 200 kilo metro rihiqu — nizikhone nay "Mengedi" — nay qedamot Kristiyanat sim — teketali nikhi'sir zefiqddu weg'awi debdabetat hatete. Asiru nifrid'n qits'at'n nab Iyerusalem kimelsom'yu zinebere witinu. Sawl ab li'ili deqi mezamurti Goyta qetali mifirrah yitenfis nebere. Tsil'u mennet'u tel'ikho'u

*nay minbar mikiniyatu koyu nebere. Tsadiq qut'e zimesilo zibeliwo seb nebere —
zigejlilo alekhu ziblo zinebere Amlak ba'ilu yiqales kem zinebere fitsum zeyifiliti.)*

Scene 5

[PICTURE: Saul and his companions traveling on a dusty road with Damascus visible in the distance. The midday sun blazes overhead. Suddenly, a blinding supernatural light — far brighter than the sun — bursts from heaven, engulfing Saul. He falls to the ground, shielding his eyes. His companions stumble in confusion. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

It happened near Damascus, around noon, when the sun was already at its brightest. Suddenly, a light from heaven — brighter than the midday sun — blazed around Saul. It was not natural light; it was the raw, unfiltered glory of the risen Christ breaking into the physical world. Saul collapsed to the ground, blinded and overwhelmed. His traveling companions heard a sound but saw no one. In a single moment, everything Saul thought he knew, everything he had built his life upon, was shattered. The hunter had become the hunted. The persecutor had been found by the One he was persecuting.

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(Ab qereba Demasqo ab qetri tsehay diro ab zibertie'lu gize tefetseme. Bidingit birhan kab semay — kab qetrawi tsehay zibelits — ab zurya Sawl nedede. Tefetroa'wi birhan ayineberen; nab qusawi alem zi'atewe nay zitens'a Kristos tiri'u zeytitserarye kibri'yu zinebere. Sawl nab midri wediqu aynu tselmitu tesenfu. Nay gu'izo bitsotu dimtsi semi'u gin manim ayre'ayun. Ab hanti himot Sawl zifilito zinebere kulu neger

*hiwetu zihanetsellu kulu neger tedemsisu. Iti hadani tehadinu'yu. Iti segwagi bi'iti
zisego zinebere terekhibu.)*

Scene 6

[PICTURE: Saul lying face-down on the ground, the brilliant heavenly light surrounding him. Above him, the glorified figure of Jesus speaks from within the radiance. Saul's hands cover his blinded eyes, his face showing shock and terror. The words "Saul, Saul" seem to echo visibly in the light. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then came the voice — personal, piercing, impossible to ignore: "Saul, Saul, why do you persecute ME?" Not "why do you persecute my followers" or "why do you persecute my church" — but ME. In that single word, Jesus revealed something revolutionary: He so completely identifies with His people that when they suffer, He suffers. Every Christian Saul had arrested, every believer he had beaten, every family he had torn apart — he had been doing it to Jesus Himself. Saul managed to whisper, "Who are you, Lord?" And the answer came: "I am Jesus, whom you are persecuting." The One Saul thought was dead was alive. The One he was fighting against was God Himself.

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(Dihri'u iti dimtsi metse — biwilqi sehabi zeytigidifo, "Sawl Sawl niminty tisegugeni?"
"Niminty teketeltey tisegug" wey "niminty bete Kristiyaney tisegug" zeyikone — ni'ay.
Ab ita hanti qal Yesus sewrawi neger geletse; mis hizbu kisab kind'u bimilu'e yilele
silezi nisatom mis zisaqeyu nisu yisaqe. Sawl zi'asero kulu Kristiyan ziwq'o kulu amani
zifelaliyo kulu sidabet — ni'Yesus ba'ilu'yu yigibro zinebere. Sawl "men ikha Goyta?"
ilu bihishukh kibil ki'ilu. Iti melsi dima metse, "Ane Yesus'ye niskha tisegugeni

zelekha." Sawl moytu ziblo zinebere hiyaw'yu. Ziqaleso zinebere Amlak ba'ilu'yu zinebere.)

Scene 7

[PICTURE: Saul being led by the hand into the city of Damascus by his confused companions. His eyes are open but see nothing — completely blind. He stumbles forward, dependent and helpless. The proud Pharisee who rode out with authority now enters like a broken beggar. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Saul opened his eyes, he could see nothing. The man who had set out with authority and power — carrying letters of arrest, leading armed men — now had to be led by the hand like a child into Damascus. For three days, Saul sat in total darkness. He didn't eat. He didn't drink. He simply sat with the devastating weight of what he had done. Every face of every Christian he had persecuted must have haunted him. God had stripped away everything Saul relied upon — his intellect, his independence, his sense of rightness — and left him with nothing but the truth: he had been wrong. Completely, terrifyingly wrong.

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(Sawl aynu mis kefete hanti'wun kiri'i ayke'alen. Bisiltan'n hayl'n wits'u zinebere seb — nay ma'iserti debdabetat hizu ituqat sebat merihu — hiji kem qol'a bi'id temeriku nab Demasqo ki'atu nebero. Niseleste me'alti Sawl ab milu'e tselmat kof bele. Ayibeli'en. Ayisteyen. Mis'ti zeskahikihi kibdet nay zigebero biqelilu kof bele. Nay kulu zisegogo Kristiyan gets kelakhelo alewo. Amlak Sawl zimirkoselu zinebere kulu —

a'imro'u natsinet'u nay qinu'enet simi'itu — qentitu bihaqi tiray gedefo; tigagiyu'yu zinebere. Bimilu'e bizefrihi megedi tigagiyu.)

Scene 8

[PICTURE: A humble Christian man named Ananias kneeling in prayer in his small home in Damascus. A divine light illuminates the room as God speaks to him. Ananias's face shows a mixture of devotion and growing fear as he listens to God's instructions. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Meanwhile, God spoke to a disciple in Damascus named Ananias through a vision: "Go to the house of Judas on Straight Street and ask for a man from Tarsus named Saul, for he is praying." Ananias was terrified. Everyone knew who Saul was — the infamous persecutor who had destroyed the church in Jerusalem. "Lord," Ananias protested, "I have heard many reports about this man and all the harm he has done to your holy people." God's response was stunning: "Go! This man is my chosen instrument to carry my name before the Gentiles and their kings and before the people of Israel." God saw what no one else could see — not who Saul was, but who Saul would become.

[illegible]

(Ab'zi gize Amlak ab Demasqo ab zinebere Ananyas zibehal hade deqe mezmur bira'iy tezarebo, "Nab geza Yihuda ab qinu'e godena kid Sawl zismu nay Terses seb hitet nisu yitsli alo." Ananyas senbede. Sawl men mkhwanu kulu seb yifilto nebere — ab Iyerusalem nibete Kristiyan zetfi'a ziteflete seqwaqi. "Goyta" Ananyas tegaweme

*"biza'iba'zi seb niqidusan hizbkha zigebero kulu gud'at bizuh tsebtsab simi'e'lekhu."
Nay Amlak melsi zisdemim nebere; "Kid! Izi seb qidmi ahizab negestatom'n qidmi
hizbi Isra'el'n simey kitsewr zimeretskwo mesarhi'yu." Amlak kal'e manim kiri'yo
zeyikhil re'aye — Sawl zinebere zeyikone Sawl zikhewn zelo.)*

Scene 9

[PICTURE: Ananias entering a dark room where blind Saul sits alone, thin and broken after three days without food. Ananias reaches out his hands toward Saul's eyes with compassion on his face. A warm golden light begins to glow between his hands and Saul's face. Something like scales shimmer on Saul's closed eyelids. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Ananias obeyed despite his fear. He found Saul and did something remarkable — he placed his hands on the man who had come to arrest him and called him "Brother Saul." Think about the courage and grace in that single word: brother. Ananias chose to see Saul not as an enemy but as a fellow human being whom God was transforming. "The Lord — Jesus, who appeared to you on the road — has sent me so that you may see again and be filled with the Holy Spirit." Immediately, something like scales fell from Saul's eyes. He could see again — not just physically, but spiritually. Everything looked different now. He was baptized, ate food, and regained his strength. The persecutor was reborn.

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(Ananyas firhatu bizeyegedis te'azeze. Ni'Sawl rekhibu zidiniq neger gebere — ab li'ili iti ki'isro zimetsee seb a'idawu anbere "haw Sawl" dima tsew'o. Ab'ta hanti qal zelo tib'at'n tsega'n hiseb, haw. Ananyas ni'Sawl kem tselai zeyikone kem Amlak ziqyiro

*zelo bitsay seb kiri'yo meretse. "Goyta — ab megedi zitera'eyeka Yesus — kitri'i
kitkhil'n bimenfes qidus kitimle'n sediduni." Biqitsibet kem qiraf zimesil neger kab
ayni Sawl wedeqe. Kem bihadish kiri'i ke'ale — bi'akal tiray zeyikone bimenfes'wun.
Kulu neger hiji filiy yimesil nebere. Tetimqe bili'e haylu dima temelise. Iti segwagi kem
bihadish tewelde.)*

Scene 10

[PICTURE: Saul — now visibly transformed with softer eyes and humble posture — standing in a Damascus synagogue, passionately preaching to stunned Jewish listeners. He points to Scripture scrolls while proclaiming Jesus as the Son of God. People look at each other in disbelief. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

What happened next shocked everyone. Saul immediately began preaching in the synagogues of Damascus that Jesus is the Son of God. The same man who had come to arrest Christians was now proclaiming the faith he had tried to destroy. People were bewildered: "Isn't this the man who raised havoc in Jerusalem among those who call on this name? Didn't he come here to take them as prisoners?" The transformation was so sudden, so complete, that people couldn't process it. But Saul grew more and more powerful in his preaching, proving from the Scriptures he had memorized as a Pharisee that Jesus was indeed the Christ. His greatest weapon against the church had become his greatest tool for building it.

[illegible]

(Dihri'u zitefetseme nikulu seb adentsewe. Sawl biqitsibet ab bet tselot Demasqo
 Yesus wedi Amlak mkhwanu kisebkh jemere. Kristiyanat ki'isir zimetsee seb hiji ketfi'o
 zifetene imnet yi'iwij nebere. Sebat teqeremu, "Izi ab Iyerusalem netom bi'izi sim

zits'iwu zetfi'a seb ayikonen'do? Kem murukhat kiwesdom aymetsen'do?" Iti lewti azyu dingetegna azyu milu'e sile zinebere sebat kirda'uwo ayke'alun. Gin Sawl ab sibiket'u ziyada hayal inakhone kede kem Ferisawi bilibu zihhazo qidus tsihuf tetiqimu Yesus bihaqi Kristos mkhwanu aregaga tse. Antsar bete Kristiyan zinebero zi'abeye atswar nimihinatsa zi'abeye mesarhi'u kone.)

Scene 11

[PICTURE: Saul arriving in Jerusalem, approaching a group of early Christian believers. They pull back in fear and suspicion, some shielding their families. Saul reaches out with open, peaceful hands, but distrust fills their eyes. The scars of his persecution still fresh in their memories. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Saul eventually came to Jerusalem, he tried to join the disciples — but they were all afraid of him. They didn't believe his conversion was real. Can you blame them? This was the man who had torn their community apart, imprisoned their friends, and approved of Stephen's murder. How do you trust someone whose hands still carry the memory of your suffering? Their suspicion was understandable, even reasonable. Trust that has been shattered takes time to rebuild. Saul had to learn that forgiveness doesn't automatically mean restored trust — that's earned through consistent, patient demonstration of change.

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(Saw! ab mewedaita nab Iyerusalem mis metse mis deqi mezamurti kihiwes fetene — gin kulom ferhwo. Lewti'u haqenya mkhwanu ayi'amenun. Kitweqisom tikhil'do? Izi mahberom zibetetene a'irukhitom zi'asere niqitlet Istifanos zitesemami'e seb'yu zinebere. A'idawu gena nay siqayka zikhri zihiza seb bikemey ti'amin? Tirtare'om kird'a zike'al'yu wala mikhnu'ywun nebere. Zitesbre mit'imimman nikhhinetes qize

*yiwesid. Sawl yiqire mibal biqetita zitehhadese mit'imimman malet kem zeyikone
kimhhar nebero — izi biqiti'e bi'tigisti nay lewti mir'ay'yu zirikeb.)*

Scene 12

[PICTURE: A warm, courageous man named Barnabas stepping between Saul and the suspicious disciples. Barnabas has his arm around Saul's shoulder, presenting him to the apostles. His face radiates trust and encouragement. The disciples begin to soften, listening to Barnabas's testimony about Saul's transformation. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Then Barnabas stepped forward — and this moment changed the course of history. Barnabas, whose name means "Son of Encouragement," took Saul to the apostles. He told them how Saul had seen the Lord on the road, how Jesus had spoken to him, and how he had preached fearlessly in Damascus. Barnabas risked his own reputation to vouch for someone no one else would trust. This is one of the most underrated acts in the entire Bible. Without Barnabas, Paul might never have been accepted by the church. Never underestimate the power of being someone who believes in others when no one else will. One person willing to take a risk on you can change everything.

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(Dihri'u Bernabas niqidmit wetse — izi himot ni'gu'izo tarikh qeyero. Bernabas tirgum simu "wedi mitibba'e" zikhone ni'Sawl nab hawaryat wesedo. Sawl ab mengedi ni'Goyta bikemey kem zire'aye Yesus bikemey kem zitezarebo ab Demasqo bidifret

*bikemey kem zisebeke negerom. Bernabas kal'e manim zey'amino seb nikimiskir nay
geza'e ri'isu kibri ab hadega aw'ale. Izi ab milu'e Metshaf Qidus kab ziqelele gimiet
zitewahbo tegbarat hade'yu. Bizey Bernabas Pawlos bibete Kristiyan fetsimu
ayimiteqebelenn neyru. Kal'e manim zey'amin kelo bikhal'ot zi'amin mkhwan haylu
fetsimka ayitin'iqo. Hade seb abakha kiftin fiqadegna kikhewn kulu neger kiqyir
yikhil.)*

Scene 13

[PICTURE: Paul (now using his Roman name) and Barnabas setting sail on a wooden ship from Antioch's harbor. The church community waves goodbye from the shore with hands raised in blessing. The sea stretches before them, representing the unknown journey ahead. A map overlay shows their missionary route across the Mediterranean. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Years of preparation followed. Saul — now increasingly called Paul, his Roman name — spent time in Arabia, returned to Damascus, served in Antioch, and grew in faith and understanding. Then the Holy Spirit said to the church in Antioch: "Set apart for me Barnabas and Saul for the work to which I have called them." Paul's missionary journeys began — three epic voyages across the Roman Empire that would transform the ancient world. The man who once traveled to destroy the faith now traveled to spread it across continents. God hadn't just forgiven Paul's past — He repurposed it. Paul's education, his Roman citizenship, his multiple languages, his tireless energy — everything that once fueled persecution now fueled the gospel.

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(Ametat nay midlaw se'abu. Sawl — hiji ziyada Pawlos bi'Romawi simu zitswa'e — ab Arab gize ahliifu nab Demasqo temelisu ab Antsokiya ageligilu ab imnet'n mirda'e'n abiyu. Dihri'u Menfes Qidus nibete Kristiyan Antsokiya "ni'Bernabas'n Sawl'n neti zitsewa'ikwom sirah fileyilom" bele. Nay Pawlos sine-li'ukhawi gu'izotat jemere — neti qintawi alem ziqeyeru ab giz'at Rom seleste abeyti gu'izotat. Hanti gize imnet nimitfae zitegwa'ize seb hiji ab ahigurat nimizrigah yigwa'az nebere. Amlak nihiluf Pawlos yiqire tiray ayibelelun — dagim ilama habo. Timhirti Pawlos Romawi zegnetu bizuhat quanquatat'u zeyhilel gulbet'u — kulu hanti gize nisidet zinidede hiji niwengel yinidid nebere.)

Scene 14

[PICTURE: Paul enduring various sufferings depicted in panels: being beaten with rods by Roman soldiers, being stoned and left for dead outside a city, locked in chains in a dark prison cell, and adrift on broken ship planks in a stormy sea. Through each scene, his face shows determination and peace. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Paul's missionary life was not glamorous — it was brutal. He later catalogued his sufferings: five times he received thirty-nine lashes from the Jews, three times beaten with rods, once stoned and left for dead, three times shipwrecked, spending a night and day in the open sea. He faced danger from rivers, bandits, his own countrymen, and false believers. He endured sleepless nights, hunger, thirst, cold, and nakedness. Yet Paul never quit. He never said, "I've suffered enough. I've earned the right to stop." The same relentless drive that once made him a persecutor now made him unstoppable for the gospel. God didn't remove Paul's intensity — He redirected it.

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(Sine-li'ukhawi hiwet Pawlos girum ayineberen — chekkan nebere. Ab dihrit siqayatu
zerizere; hamushte gize kab Ayhud 39 girfi teqebilu seleste gize bibetri tegherifu
hanti gize bi'imni tewqi'u moytu tebahhilu tegediifu seleste gize merkeb tesebirati'o
leyt'n me'alt'n ab kifut bahri ahliifu. Kab wehayiz kab keterti kab nay geza'e hageru

*sebat kab hasewti aminti hadega gegtimwo. Bizey diqas leytaa timeet tsim'i quri
irqaan tseliyu. Gin Pawlos fetsimu aygedefen. "Akhiluni siqay. Kigidif higi aleni" fetsimu
aybelen. Hanti gize segwagi zigebero zikhone zeyhilel dif'it hiji niwengel zey'iget
gebero. Amlak nibirte'e Pawlos ayelgeson — anfetu qeyero.)*

bitirgum'n iti zitselmete se'at. Pawlos'n Silas'n di'a intay geberu? Ni'Amlak mezmur zemeru. Nay tesfa miqurats bihishukh tselotat zeyikone kal'ot isunat kisimi'wo zikhilu bizihan nay misgana deriftat. Ab firqi leyti Amlak seret bet ma'iserti zinqetqete kulu ma'itso zikhefete kulu senselet zelahlihe minqitqat midri sedede. Iti halaw bet ma'iserti nebsu kiqetil ziqerebe bi'i'u leyti — mis milu'e sidrabet'u — ab kind'u dehane. Pawlos nay bet ma'iserti agar nimisgana ki'agit kem zeyikhil senseletat dima niwengel ki'asir kem zeyikhil rekebe. Kunetatkha ni'amilkhokha aywisinon.)

Bahlom ayenashewon; nay mit'isisar netbi rekebe — "nizeyifiltiwo Amlak" zibil tsihuf zilewo mesewi — neti haqenya Amlak nimi'iwaj tetiquemellu. Nay Pawlos bilutsinet zeli'alemawi haqi binefsi wekef sema'i bizirda'o quanqua nay mirda'e ki'iletu'yu zinebere. "Nikulu seb kulu neger" kone — neti mel'ikhti bimidingats zeyikone kemey geyru kem ziemeahalfo bimiqyar. Izi imnet mikifal imnet'n a'imro'n tib'at'n bahlawi niqihat'n kem zihattit yimihrena.)

*debdabe haqenya tsege mat bi'Amlak tsega ziseretu haqenya fitah aqemete. Pawlos
nay gwas a debdabetat'u qidus tsihuf kem zikhewn — ab ashihat ametat bilyonat
sebat qalatu kem zinibibu — fetsimu ayhhaseben. Amlak nay qedmay segwagi biri'i
wesidu zeli'alemawi haqi nikitsihif tetiquemelu. Lomi bi'imnet tifetro fetisimka
nizyetirio weledotat kitseliho yikhil.)*

hiyab Amlak'yu — bigibri zeyikone manim keyimikah." Izi mel'ikhti sewrawi nebere mikiniyatu Pawlos ba'ilu kab zikhone seb nila'ili nimengedi gibri birtu'e fetinwo'yu. Awra haymanotawi tewasa'ay neyru — nab ti'ibit chikane tiray'n badonet'n tiray kem zimerih bitemokro yifiliti nebere. Tsega yetihitena mikiniyatu; fiqri Amlak kitrekiba aytikhiln'yu zibil. Kitqebela tiray tikhil.)

Scene 19

[PICTURE: Paul standing boldly before a Roman court, chains on his wrists but his posture upright and dignified. Roman officials, King Agrippa, and a large crowd listen as Paul declares his faith without shame. His face shows absolute conviction. A banner-like glow behind him reads the words of Romans 1:16. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

When Paul stood before rulers and kings, he declared without hesitation: "I am not ashamed of the gospel, because it is the power of God that brings salvation to everyone who believes." This was not mere rhetoric — it was tested conviction. Paul said this as a prisoner, as a man who had lost everything the world values: status, comfort, freedom, safety. He was not ashamed because he had experienced the gospel's power firsthand. It had transformed him from a murderer into a messenger, from a destroyer into a builder. When you have experienced God's grace that deeply, the opinions of the world lose their power over you.

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(Pawlos ab qidmi gezà'it'n negestat'n mis dew bele bizew miqibat aweje, "Biwengel ayhafirn'ye mikiniyatu nikulu zi'amin dihinnet zemtsi'e hayli Amlak'yu." Izi tera zereba ayineberen — zitemermmere imnet'yu zinebere. Pawlos nezi kem isur kem alem waga zihibbo kulu — dereja rahwa natsinet dihininnet — zise'ane seb'yu zibelo. Ayhaferen mikiniyatu nay wengel hayli biqetita temokurwo sile zinebere. Kab qetali

*nab li'ukh kab afrasi nab hanatsi qeyrwo nebere. Nay Amlak tsega kisab kind'u amiq
mis timokuro ri'iyto alem ab li'iliekha zilewo hayli yise'an.)*

zibelitsu tsibuqat'n tesfa zihibu'n kifalat yihazu. Kab Romawi kifli mis halewti te'asiru Pawlos tsehafe, "Kulu gize bi'Goyta tehaggosu. Kem bihadish kiblo'ye, tehaggosu!" Ni'Filipi sebat ma'isirtu bihaqi niwengel kem zi'abbeyo negerom mikiniyatu milu'e nay bete nigus halewti biza'iba Kristos simi'om sile zineberu. Pawlos nay igibet misitir temahiru — kunetat bimiyyar zeyikone kunetat bizeyegedis Kristos akhul bimkhwanu. Hagosu ab natsinet zimirikios ayineberen; ab zikhone bet ma'iserti kihizo zeyikhil seret zitesrete'yu zinebere.)

Scene 21

[PICTURE: A split image showing Paul's "before and after" — on the left, young Saul holding chains and breathing threats with dark, angry eyes; on the right, older Paul with gentle eyes, hands open in blessing, surrounded by diverse believers he has loved and mentored. A cross of light divides the two images. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Paul never forgot what he had been. He called himself "the worst of sinners" and "one abnormally born" — referring to the unusual, violent way he came to faith. But he didn't wallow in guilt; he used his past as evidence of God's limitless grace. "But for that very reason I was shown mercy so that in me, the worst of sinners, Christ Jesus might display his immense patience as an example for those who would believe in him." Paul's past became his most powerful sermon. Your worst chapters don't disqualify you — surrendered to God, they become your most compelling testimony.

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(Pawlos fetsimu intay kem zinebere ayiresi'en. Nigeza'e ri'isu "awra hati'ategna" "bizey gize'u zitewelde" ilu tsew'o — nab imnet nimetselu zeylimud ametsaw megedi amelkitu. Gin ab nay tef'e simi'it ayitehalenn; nihilufu kem nay deret ziyblu tsega Amlak mert'o tetiquemelu. "Gin biflay bi'izi mikiniyat mihhired tera'eyeni abay awra hati'ategna Kristos Yesus netom bi'i'u ki'aminu zelewom abinetot koynu zeyiwida'e

*ti'igistu ker'i'i." Nay Pawlos hiluf zihayeke sibiket'u kone. Zikhif'u mi'irafatkha
ayebqi'ukhan — ni'Amlak mis tihidegom zibeletsee zesi'in miskrnetkha yikhonu.)*

Scene 22

[PICTURE: Paul mentoring young Timothy, a shy but earnest teenager. Paul places his hand on Timothy's shoulder with fatherly warmth. They sit together studying scrolls. In the background, other young leaders Paul has trained — Titus, Silas, Luke — carry the gospel to new regions. The torch of faith being passed to the next generation. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Paul didn't just spread the gospel — he invested in people. He mentored Timothy, a young man he called "my true son in the faith," encouraging him: "Don't let anyone look down on you because you are young, but set an example in speech, in conduct, in love, in faith and in purity." Paul poured into Titus, Silas, Luke, Priscilla, Aquila, and countless others. He understood that the gospel's survival depended not on one person's brilliance but on faithful multiplication. The greatest leaders don't create followers — they create other leaders. Paul's legacy lives on not just in his letters but in the people he empowered.

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(Pawlos wengel tiray ayizerigihen — ab sebat wefere. Ab imnet "haqenya wedey" ilu zitsew'o min'isey Timotewos aseletene atebab'o, "Ni'ishto sile zikhonka manim ayine'aqkha gin ab zereba ab akayda ab fiqri ab imnet ab nitsihina abinetot kun." Pawlos ab Titos, Silas, Luqas, Pirisqila, Aqila kemu'wun zeyiqitseru kal'ot wefere. Nay wengel mitsinan ab bilitsinet hade seb zeyikone ab imun mibzah kem zimirikios teredae. Zi'abeyu merahiti teketeli ayifetrun — kal'ot merahiti'yom zifetru. Nay

*Pawlos wirisha ab debdabetat'u tiray zeyikone ab ziberata'inayom sebat'wun
hiyyaw'yu.)*

Scene 23

[PICTURE: Paul as an elderly man, weathered but peaceful, writing his final letter to Timothy. His cell is sparse but his face glows with contentment. He writes the words "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race." A crown of light waits above him, symbolizing his eternal reward. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Near the end of his life, facing execution in Rome, Paul wrote his final words to Timothy: "I have fought the good fight, I have finished the race, I have kept the faith. Now there is in store for me the crown of righteousness, which the Lord, the righteous Judge, will award to me on that day." There was no regret in these words — only the quiet confidence of a man who had given everything and held nothing back. Paul had run his race to completion. He didn't just start well; he finished well. The Christian life is not a sprint — it's a marathon. And the goal is not applause from the crowd but the words, "Well done, good and faithful servant."

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(Nay hiwet'u meweda'ita qeribu ab Rom qitlet gegtimwo kelo Pawlos nay meweda'ita qalat'u ni'Timotewos tsehafe, "Tsibuq qalsi teqalise guya wedi'e imnet haliye. Hiji nay tsidqi akhlil tedaiyuley alo Goyta iti tsadiq feradi bi'i'u me'alti zihibeni." Ab izen qalat ta'isa ayineberen — kulu zihabe hanti'wun zeyihaze seb hidu'e mit'imimman tiray. Pawlos guya'u kisab miwida'e goyyu. Tsibuq tiray ayijemerem; tsibuq'wun wede'a.

Kristiyanawi hiwet hatsirti guya ayikonen — maraton'yu. Ilama dima nay seb taq'it zeyikone "tsibuuq geyrka hiyaway amin agelgali" zibil qal'yu.)

aregit Sawl — iti segwagi qetali bitsili'i zitebal'e haymanotawi qin'iteгна — halifu'yu. Iti hadish Pawlos — hawarya agelgali nisebat mifqar kab migidaf mimawt zimrits seb — metsi'u. Izi lewti qes biqes mimihiyash ri'iskha ayineberen. Li'ile-tefetroa'wi dagim mifitar'yu zinebere. Amlak neti aregit Sawl ayetsebiqon; milu'e bimilu'e hadish fitret gebere. Tsega zigebro izi'yu — zineberkayo yiqire tiray ayibilin; bigeza'e ri'iskha kitkono fetsimka zeymikhalkha gele neger yigebreka.)

kindey tselmitu bizeyegedis — bi'ilama zimel'a metsai ayebqi'ekan. Nigiega zimerhaka zikhone hirfan nikibri Amlak kiqyer yikhil. Nizikhif'a limidkha zinidid gulbet neti zi'abeye tsaw'itkha kinidid yikhil. Tsega yiqire mibal tiray ayikonen — lewti'yu. Amlak men mkhwanka temitu men kitkhewn kem tikhil ziri'i'yu. Bizikhif'a himotkha aytiglets'n ikha. Natu bizbleka Amlak ikha tiglets.)

The Moral of the Story

No one is too far gone for God's grace. God can transform our greatest weaknesses into our greatest strengths. The same passion that drives us wrong can be redirected for God's purposes. Past failures don't disqualify us from future calling — surrendered to God, they become our most powerful testimony. Grace is scandalous — it reaches those we think don't deserve it, including ourselves. God doesn't just forgive what we were; He transforms us into what we could never become alone. One person believing in you — like Barnabas believed in Paul — can change the entire trajectory of your life.

[illegible]

(Nitsega Amlak azyu zirehhaqe manim yelen. Amlak zi'abeye dikhamnana nab zi'abeye haylna kiyir yikhil. Nigiega zimerhana zikhone hirfan ni'ilama Amlak kiyer yikhil. Nay hiluf widqetat kab nay metsai tsaw'it ayeqb'i'enan — ni'Amlak mis nihidego zihayele miskrnetna yikhonu. Tsega zisdemim'yu — kem zeyibi'q'u nihisbom sebat ni'ana hawisna yibetsih. Amlak zinebernayo yiqire tiray ayibilin; beyinna fetsimna kinkono zeynikhil nab zikhone yiqyirena. Hade seb abakha zi'amin — kem Bernabas ab Pawlos zi'amene — nimilu'e anfet hiwetkha kiyir yikhil.)



Bible Verse / ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅጽ

"Therefore, if anyone is in Christ, the new creation has come:
The old has gone, the new is here!" — 2 Corinthians 5:17

"ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅጽ ቅጽ ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅጽ ቅጽ ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት ቅጽ
ቅጽ ቅጽ ቅጽ ቅጽ!" — 2 ቅዱስ መጻሕፍት 5:17

*("Silezi zikhone seb ab Kristos inte alo hadish fitret'yu, iti aregit halifu inho
kulu hadish koynu!" — 2 Qorenthos 5:17)*

need to "earn" God's love or prove yourself worthy? How does understanding grace change the way you view yourself and others?

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5. Paul's story shows that God doesn't waste our past — even our failures and sins can be repurposed for His glory. What experiences in your life — including mistakes or struggles — might God use for good in the future? How does this perspective change the way you view your own story?

5. ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ — ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ — ስለሆነ ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ? ስለ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ ስለሆነ?

Prayer / ማጽናት

Lord Jesus, You met Saul on the road to Damascus — the man who hated You most — and You transformed him into the man who loved You most. We stand in awe of a grace that reaches the unreachable and transforms the untransformable. If You could change Paul, You can change anyone — including us. We surrender our past to You — every failure, every shame, every wrong turn. We trust that in Your hands, nothing is wasted. Redirect our passions for Your purposes. Take whatever drives us — our intensity, our ambition, our restlessness — and turn it toward Your kingdom. Help us to be like Barnabas — people who believe in others when no one else will. And when the world tells us we are defined by our worst moments, remind us that we are defined by Your grace. We are new creations. The old has gone. The new is here. In Your powerful name, Amen.

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(Goyta Yesus ni'Sawl ab mendedi Demasqo rekhebkayo — ni'akha zibeletsee zitseli'aka seb — nab zibeletsee zifeteweka seb qeyerkayo. Zeyibitsah zibetsih

zeyiqyer ziqyir tsega nidiineq. Ni'Pawlos kitqyir zikhalkha nizikhone — ni'ana hawisna — kitqyir tikhil ikha. Hilufna ni'akha nihidego — kulu widqet kulu hisran kulu giega anfet. Ab a'idawka hanti neger kem zeyibakhin ni'amin. Nihirfanna ni'ilamakha qeyro. Zidirkhena zikhone — birte'ena shewhatinat zeyrig'atna — wesidka nab mengistkha qeyro. Kem Bernabas kinikhewn hagizena — kal'e manim zey'amin kelo bikhal'ot zi'aminu sebat. Alem bizikhif'a himoatna nigilets ina mis ziblenna bitsegakha nigilets kem zelena azekakhirena. Hadesti fitretat ina. Iti aregit halifu. Iti hadish abzi alo. Bihayal simka Amen.)

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

Book 49 of 60

Thank you for reading! We pray this story reminds you that no one is beyond God's transforming grace. Whatever your past holds, God sees not who you are but who you can become. May you have the courage to let Him redirect your passions, the humility to receive His grace, and the faith to believe that your story is still being written.

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